

Said Azaizah

MIT '30 • Course 6-14 (CS, Economics, Data Science) • Cambridge, MA
az_said@mit.edu • +1 617-803-5357 • linkedin.com/in/said-azaizah • saidazaizah.com
Arabic (native) • Hebrew (native) • English (fluent)

VENTURES & ENTREPRENEURSHIP

Co-Founder & CTO, RoofMate

Jan 2024 – present

Israeli-Palestinian roommate matching • AppsFlyer Accelerator • 20 hr/wk

- Led an **11-person Israeli-Palestinian team** to ship the Android MVP: 500+ signups, 4 university partnerships, Haifa pilot planned.
- Architected bias-aware matching on MongoDB vector search and HuggingFace embeddings — interests and habits, not nationality.
- Founded as EmpowerED and pivoted through MEET Accelerator once validation showed roommate matching was the sharper problem. Revenue reinvested into a scholarship fund for Palestinian students.

Co-Founder, Interlock

Sep 2026 – present

Battle of the Coasts intercollegiate hackathon, Cloud AI track

- Commit-gate + receipt layer that makes AI-agent payments at-most-once and auditable. Validated on live Stripe test mode: plain retry pays wrong in **9 of 10** injected faults; the gate, 0.
- Runs a public claims ledger: every published number is reproduced by a script in the repo, and an unledgered number is classified as a bug.

Team Lead, Shaman — 1st Place, HUJI AI Hackathon

2025

- Led concept and data logic for an assistant that reads government PDFs and fills forms in Arabic or Hebrew through chat.
- Learned React and TypeScript from scratch and won in **36 hours**; the hackathon was originally restricted to bachelor's holders.

RESEARCH & ENGINEERING

Lead Developer, Peptide Visual Lab (PVL)

Sep 2025 – present

Technion (Prof. Meytal Landau) / DESY-CSSB, Hamburg • 20 hr/wk, paid

- With zero biology background, learned the science from postdocs and shipped a working prototype in **two weeks**. Prof. Landau hired me on the spot.
- Adopted by **HIFIS (Helmholtz Association)** after multiple evaluation rounds. Migrated off managed cloud to a self-hosted Kubernetes deployment, saving **\$600+/month**; a DESY-CSSB instance is in preparation.
- Serving **50+ researchers across 4 labs**, saving ~30 lab-hours/week. Open-source and MIT-licensed, with two published PyPI packages; methods paper in preparation.
- Open commercialization question I am actively working: how a research-born tool captures value through institutional deployment contracts rather than per-seat licensing. Next milestone is the first precomputed structural proteome — **~570K** UniProt proteins pre-analyzed.

DESY Delegate & Research Intern

Dec 2024 – Sep 2025

DESY / Weizmann Institute of Science

- Selected as **1 of 3 students in Israel**. Coursework in particle acceleration, relativity, and quantum mechanics. Assisted beam-diagnostics research and presented findings to DESY mentors and Weizmann faculty.

Selected for Sharpies Elite Tech Talent Cohort

May 2025

- Declined placement to lead PVL development at the Technion full-time.

LEADERSHIP & INSTITUTIONAL

Orbit Ambassador & Student Board of Advisors, Class of 2030

Aug 2026 – present

Martin Trust Center for MIT Entrepreneurship

- Selected as Class of 2030 ambassador for **Orbit**, the Trust Center's platform for MIT student founders — built on Bill Aulet's Disciplined Entrepreneurship and licensed beyond MIT to Bentley, TEX-E, and MIT Solve.
- Member of the Trust Center's **Student Board of Advisors**, working alongside President Adam Elitzur, founder of MIT's Startup Career Fair.
- Direct product-feedback relationship with Product Lead Doug Williams as Orbit consolidates into the Entrepreneurship Hub.

CS Instructor, MEET

Jul 2025 – present

- Hand-selected by MEET's CEO from the TA cohort. Taught **120 binational students** across Y2 and Y3 in Flask, Firebase, and applied AI.
- Co-designed the **first fundamental redesign of MEET's Y2 curriculum since 2015** with the co-founder and CS lead, moving it from DHTML to AI systems: automation, agent design, infrastructure.
- Built MEET's enterprise automation platform — 10 plugins, 35 skills for instructor feedback and submission scoring — running at **\$75/month** against a \$5,600/year commercial equivalent.
- Built MEET's crowdfunding platform solo as technical product manager — **7,000+ users across 14 student startups**, shipped in 44 days, three languages with full RTL. React, TypeScript, Supabase, Cloudflare.

ML Intern, BetterMind Labs

Jul 2025 – present

- Advanced to the 12-week Advanced Track: **top 9 of ~1,100 applicants**. Named among “top performing students.”

Math & CS Mentor, Leyada

2022 – 2025

- Established a peer-tutoring program pairing Arabic- and Hebrew-speaking students. Designed a story-strategy-solve framework that raised grades by up to 40%. The program still runs today.

EDUCATION

Massachusetts Institute of Technology

Fall 2026 – 2030

- B.S. in Computer Science, Economics, and Data Science (Course 6-14). DEAL FPOP alumnus, Martin Trust Center.

MEET (Middle East Entrepreneurs of Tomorrow)

2021 – present

- Three-year selective program in partnership with MIT. Student '24 → LEAD '25 (selected **15 of 130 alumni**) → Entrepreneurship TA → CS Instructor. Grade: Outstanding. 1st Place, Meta Competition Y1.

Hebrew University Secondary School (Leyada)

2019 – 2025

- Israel's most selective school for gifted students. Only Arab student in cohort. **Top 0.1% national rank**, 118.1/100 Technion weighted Bagrut average.

Weizmann Institute of Science, Dual Enrollment

2022 – 2025

- Intensive Physics program at research level, Reisman Science Education Center.

VOLUNTEERING

Community Recovery Volunteer

2023 – 2025

Regional Farms & Retirement Homes • 180+ hours

- Joined Jewish-Israeli friends volunteering after Oct 7. Excellence in Voluntary Commitment award.

Cancer Database System

Feb 2026 – present

- Built a secure patient database for my uncle, a pulmonologist, tracking smoking-related respiratory malignancies and disease-progression correlations.

ARTS

Lead Performer (Rawis / Soloist), Palestinian Dabka

2015 – present

- Elite 11-member Jerusalem troupe. Nine years, **42 original performances**. International festivals: Spain (2022), Budapest (2023, a 16-minute coexistence narrative). Led the troupe since 7th grade.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Python, JavaScript/TypeScript, Java, SQL, HTML/CSS

Frontend: React, React Native, Next.js, Vite, Tailwind, Android Studio (Java/XML)

Backend & Data: FastAPI, Flask, Node.js, Firebase, Supabase, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, SQLite

DevOps: Docker, Kubernetes, ArgoCD, Rancher, Nginx, Caddy, Cloudflare, Vercel, Sentry

ML: HuggingFace (embeddings, transformers), PyTorch, S4PRED, TANGO

AI-Augmented Development: Designed a multi-terminal orchestration methodology with custom governance rules and automated quality hooks across three production codebases.

LINKS & PORTFOLIO

Portfolio saidazaizah.com

GitHub github.com/az-said

LinkedIn in/said-azaizah

Interlock interlock-self.vercel.app

PVL peptide_prediction

PVL docs az-said.github.io

Crowdfunding meet-kickstarter.com

Shaman HUJI_Hackathon

RoofMate RoofMateExpoNight